

Martha could have probably qualified for food stamps, donated clothing, transportation subsidies, and other assistance programs based on her low income. In addition, there are numerous nonprofit organizations that assist in locating absent spouses. Once he or she is located, this information can then be given to the district attorney's office to collect alimony or back child support. Through the garnishment of wages, levying of bank account funds, or seizing of income tax refunds, the delinquency can be made current.

The trauma of going through a divorce is stressful enough without the additional emotional upheaval of a bankruptcy. If there would have been any alternative to filing bankruptcy, Martha should have considered any and all of the options available to her. Starting over after a divorce is a new beginning, but a bankruptcy is not. The illusion is that you are free of debt, but the reality is that its repercussions are felt for a long time after.

A Lucky Break in Hollywood

It is difficult to budget on an irregular income. When money comes sporadically, it is hard to know how much you can spend monthly. When the money is “not” there, you watch every penny you spend and live frugally. The problem usually results when the money “is” there. Then your tendency is to spend, spend, and spend. Your excitement of finally receiving money blunts your survival instinct.

Quinton wanted to be a screenwriter in Hollywood. He was only twenty-one, but had been working for three years since high school to make this dream a reality. First, he worked on finishing a script and then on finding a filmmaker who would buy it. While he was waiting for his lucky break, he worked as a waiter alongside others like himself. He worked with aspiring singers, comedians, and actors. They all shared

